

Session 10 Homework — Finish the Filter

CORE, STRETCH, and CHALLENGE are all required — every one of them must be completed. The three names describe increasing difficulty only, nothing about which parts you submit.

Context

This extends `AllExceptionsFilter`, built in class today (`api/src/common/filters/all-exceptions.filter.ts`), registered globally in `main.ts` via `app.useGlobalFilters(...)`. It already separates known errors (already an `HttpException`, passed straight through) from unknown ones (logged on the server, hidden from the client, reported as a generic `500` that already includes a `path` field — built live in class).

Goal

Make the generic (unknown-error) response even more useful to debug, and write down the one real design decision in the filter that isn't obvious from the code alone.

What to build

A `timestamp` field on the generic-error response, alongside the `path` already added in class (CORE), a `method` field alongside it (STRETCH), and a short written comment on the `instanceof HttpException` check in `api/src/common/filters/all-exceptions.filter.ts` explaining why the filter preserves this app's own already-correct error responses instead of replacing them (CHALLENGE).

CORE (required)

Add a `timestamp` field (an ISO string) to the generic-error response, alongside the `path` field already there from class.

STRETCH (required)

Add a `method` field to the same response — read from the same request object already used for `path` — right alongside `timestamp`.

CHALLENGE (required)

Add a short code comment directly above the `if (exception instanceof HttpException)` line, explaining in your own words why this check matters for THIS app's own current errors.

Rules

Allowed: everything taught in Session 10 — the same `request` object already used for `path` (now also read via `request.method`), plain JavaScript `Date`, a code comment (no new decorators, no new packages). **Not yet:** no guards, no custom decorators, no database, no changes to the `HttpException`

passthrough branch (it must stay exactly as it was).

Test it

BASH

```
curl -i -X POST localhost:3000/workspaces -H "Content-Type: application/json" -d '{"name": 123, "slug": "hw-test"}'
```

Done when

- The generic `500` response includes `path`, `timestamp`, AND `method`.
- An ordinary `404` / `409` response (e.g. `GET /projects/999`) is completely unchanged.
- `npm run start:dev` starts with no errors and no warnings in the terminal.
- You can explain, out loud, why the filter checks `instanceof HttpException` before deciding what to send the client.

Working time

Expect roughly 20–25 minutes total across all three tiers.